

Agenda - Member Meeting 2019-08-26

So we can move through our business more smoothly, please review the background information (on the following pages) while you wait for the meeting to start.

1. **OFFICIAL RESULTS of RANKED CHOICE VOTE at JUNE 24 MEMBER MEETING: PROCESS E WAS CHOSEN.**

Statement of Process E and information about governance restrictions, and their effects on Process E, are presented on the next page.

2. Our main goal tonight is to decide how to implement Process E.

A. Revise wording of Process E (5 minutes) VOTE

The Board suggests the Membership change the wording in the first sentence of Process E to say: "Switch one Monday per month to **Gender Free** and have the rest be gendered. Do this for a while and watch how that works out."

B. When to start Process E (10 minutes) VOTE

The Board suggests we begin using process E in the month of January, 2020. Please see next page for reason.

C. Regularly recurring Monday or variable (5 minutes) VOTE

The Board recommends that members choose 1 pre-defined Monday per month for gender-free calling. See next page for reason.

D. If regularly recurring, decide which Monday (10 minutes) VOTE

The Board recommends every 4th Monday, so as not to negatively impact attendance at the second Saturday contra dance.

E. How long to continue Process E (10 minutes) VOTE

F. Whether to extend Interim Policy until Process E starts (10 minutes) VOTE

If Process E is not starting immediately, a new vote is required. See Page 3 for reason and the full language of the original policy.

G. Ideas about Benchmarks. Information only at this point. Please see Pages 3 – 4.

Background

I. Statement of Process E:

“Switch one Monday per month to Larks & Ravens and have the rest be gendered. Do this for a while and watch how that works out.

“For example ... Set the 3rd Monday of each month as Gender Free and track weekly attendance for a year to evaluate. Before starting, establish benchmarks to decide whether to

- i. ultimately keep the 3rd Monday schedule or
- ii. add another gender-free dance each month or
- iii. drop the gender-free dance”

II. Cincinnati Contra Dance is a 501c3. 501c3 status gives permission by the federal government to run an organization as a tax-free entity. A 501c3 is listed as an organization that provides charitable and/or educational activities to its membership and the community at large. The 501c3 status requires the organization to guarantee its membership and donors that its business will be handled with fiscal and ethical integrity.

III. At the 6/24/19 Member Meeting, the votes electing Process E were counted after the meeting had closed. Thus, there was a perceived conflict among some members between Process E and the interim policy. However, since the votes on Process E were counted after the June 24 meeting, the results are to be officially reported at the next membership meeting (on 8/26/19). Then the members can determine when and how to implement Process E. The *Interim Policy* that was voted on has a time limitation, so the *Interim Policy* ends at the next general membership meeting (in other words, on 8/26/19).

IV. The Board can make suggestions to the membership on how to proceed with Process E at the August 26 meeting, but the members are to make the final determination on the procedures to follow in implementing Process E. Also, if a set date is established to begin Process E, the members will determine whether to extend the *Interim Policy* until the date that Process E starts.

A. Revise wording of Process E? (This paragraph is identical to the corresponding paragraph on Pg 1.)

The Board suggests the Membership change the wording in the first sentence of Process E to say: “Switch one Monday per month to **Gender Free** and have the rest be gendered. Do this for a while and watch how that works out.”

B. When to start?

Since the 2019 schedule is already confirmed with bands and callers, the Board suggests we begin using process E in the month of January, 2020. Otherwise, a major upheaval of the painfully-arrived-at schedule would be necessary.

C. Regularly recurring Monday or variable?

The Board recommends that members choose 1 pre-defined Monday per month for gender-free calling. This will help dancers plan further ahead if they prefer to come only on nights with some specific caller language.

D. If regularly recurring, which Monday?

The Board recommends every 4th Monday, so as not to negatively impact attendance at the 2nd Saturday contra dance.

E. How long to run?

The Board tabled the proposal to offer a recommendation on this question.

F. Extend Interim Policy until Process E starts?

Here is the full language of the original interim policy, which the members approved on June 24:

Interim Policy, also known as “Callers’ Choice”, also known as
“Time Limited Policy and Procedures for Dance Callers”

“Time of Implementation – between the general membership meeting of June 24, 2019 and the immediately-following general meeting.

Policy, for the time period stated, experienced callers will be allowed to choose dance terminology (terminology for this policy is to mean gendered or gender free language).

PROCEDURES

- 1) Callers who are hired are to be informed of the sensitivities and discussions among the membership of the Contra Dancers on the issue of gender free calling
- 2) The board of the Cincinnati Contra Dancers, at least one week in advance, will post on website and social media, the callers hired for that dance and the terminology they will be using to lead the dances.
- 3) This policy is no longer in affect after the general membership meeting immediately following the June 24, 2019 meeting.”

This policy authorized Callers’ Choice until the next Members’ Meeting. Now we need to vote again on the interim policy (Callers’ Choice) to decide whether to continue Callers’ Choice until Process E starts.

G. Benchmarks?

The Board recognizes that it will be difficult to discern dancers’ preferences and the intensity of their preferences regarding callers’ role terminology based purely on attendance, because there are so many confounding factors. These factors include:

- I. Individual preferences for individual callers
- II. Individual preferences for individual bands
- III. Injuries that render a dancer unable to dance for varying periods of time
- IV. Individual schedule constraints, such as work and school schedules
- V. Holiday periods when individuals have more schedule flexibility

- VI Vacation periods
 - i. During vacation, local dancers may travel away from Cincinnati.
 - ii. During vacation, out-of-town dancers may come to Cincinnati Contra while traveling to or through Cincinnati.
- VII. Weather
 - i. Bad weather can make it hard to drive a distance for Contra.
 - ii. Good weather can mean that people are exhausted from a day of yardwork, biking, etc.
 - iii. Good weather can mean that people decide to continue yardwork, biking, etc into the evening (and thus skip dance).

Because of all these different factors affecting attendance, the Board has voted to develop a short survey. The survey will let each dancer evaluate the caller and the band each Monday. It will let us tally attendance and include a question about folks' attendance specifically relating to GF or non-GF calling. We'll run the survey for a 12-month period, starting as soon as possible. We intend that this survey will provide information to help tease out the varying effects of different factors on attendance. Thus it should help compile results of the benchmarks.

The survey will be ready soon, and the Board will be able to suggest benchmarks then.